

Concept Handbook

Kultsa Co-Lab Program



This concept handbook is a result of our 6 week co-creation process. It has been designed to inspire and support your work. Feel free to interpret and apply it in ways that best fit your context.

Table of Content

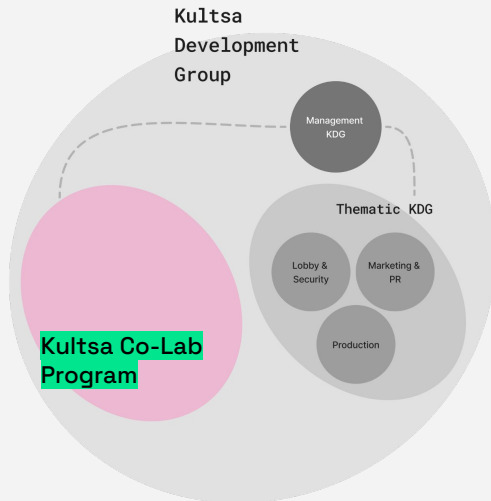
Intro	3
Overview Program	4
Program Principles	5
Program Structure	6
Roadmap	14

Intro

The **Kultsa Development Group** is **uniquely positioned** to mobilize cultural change by representing, engaging and connecting employees from different roles across organizations.

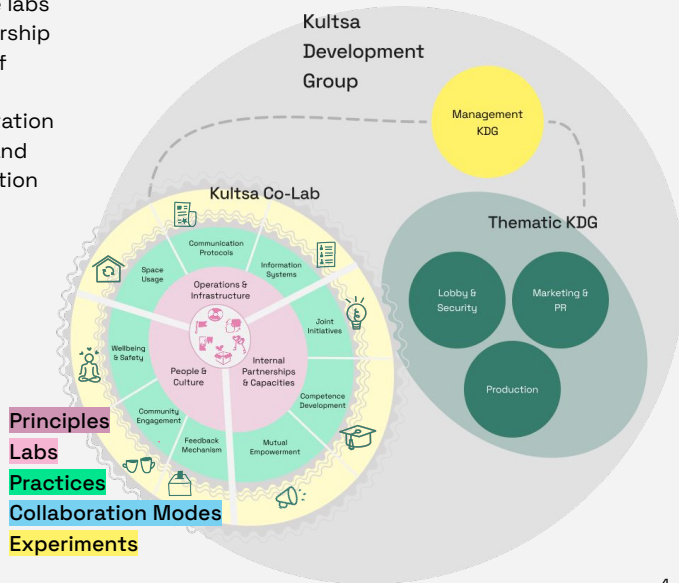
Building on the existing Kultsa Development Group ecosystem, we are introducing the Kultsa Co-Lab Program — **a new, experimental way of working** that is designed to help the Espoo Cultural Centre grow from a workplace into a self-developing community of practice.

With a major renovation beginning in 2026, this disruption creates a rare **opportunity to co-create and test new ideas** that shape the cultural centre's future.



Overview Program

- guided by principles
- organized by people within three labs
- activated by practices and ownership
- strengthening different modes of collaboration
- driven by co-created experimentation
- anchored in knowledge sharing and iteration, resulting in implementation for long-term change



Program Principles

Principles

Labs

Practices

Collaboration Modes

Experiments

The Kultsa Co-Lab Program is **grounded in way-of-working principles** that shape how change should feel and be practiced.



We try out new things and set new standards.



We create a safe space to experiment, express and reflect.



We regularly communicate progress and obstacles to keep our program in motion.



Every member brings equally important and valid perspectives.



We are excited to try new and creative approaches.



We own our practices individually and as a group.

Program Structure

The program is organized **by people within three labs.**

Each Lab has its **own focus** which represents the areas most relevant for a future-oriented Cultural Centre.

Principles
Labs
Practices
Collaboration Modes
Experiments

Operations & Infrastructure Lab

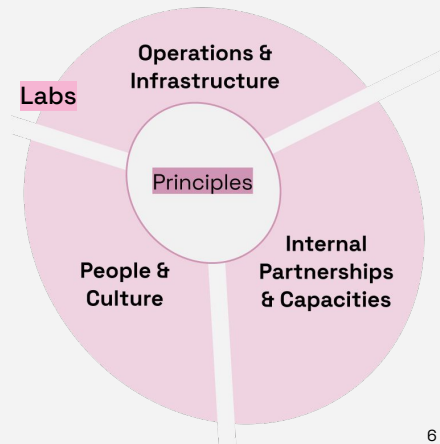
Focuses on strategic use of resources that support collaboration and clear information flows.

People & Culture Lab

Focuses on strengthening wellbeing, inclusion, safety, and community engagement.

Internal Partnerships & Capacities Lab

Focuses on competence development and strengthening ties across organizations.



Program Structure

Each Lab brings together **people from different organizations who act as facilitators of change** and put the principles into practice.

Principles

Labs

Practices

Collaboration Modes

Experiments

While all serving as facilitators of change, they each have **different roles**:

Coordinator

Leads meetings and manages time and discussions.

Secretary

Takes notes and tracks actions and goals.

Resource Responsible

Manages time, space, and budget.

Communication Responsible

Oversees internal and external communication.

Insight Collector

Gathers feedback from outside the lab.



Program Structure

Each Lab works through three **practices** that serve as entry points for new ways of working together.

These practices are **owned by the people**, who set their own tasks, goals, and decisions, and take responsibility for shaping outcomes.



Program Structure

Principles

Labs

Practices

Collaboration Modes

Experiments

Information System

Establishing clear practices for keeping people and activities visible and accessible. Defining where, and when information should be shared.

Communication Protocol

Aligning on methods for contacting and responding across organizations.

Space Usage

Defining practices for reserving and utilizing shared, private, formal, and informal spaces effectively.

Wellbeing & Safety

Promoting inclusion, emotional safety, and care for all individuals within the organization.

Community Engagement

Enabling casual interactions through shared spaces, communication channels, and organized events.

Feedback Mechanisms

Creating channels and guidelines for reflection, input, idea sharing, and constructive conflict resolution.

Mutual Empowerment

Equipping organizations to support one another through recognition, co-promotion, and sharing of resources.

Joint Initiatives

Exploring opportunities and developing projects that multiple organizations can collaborate on together.

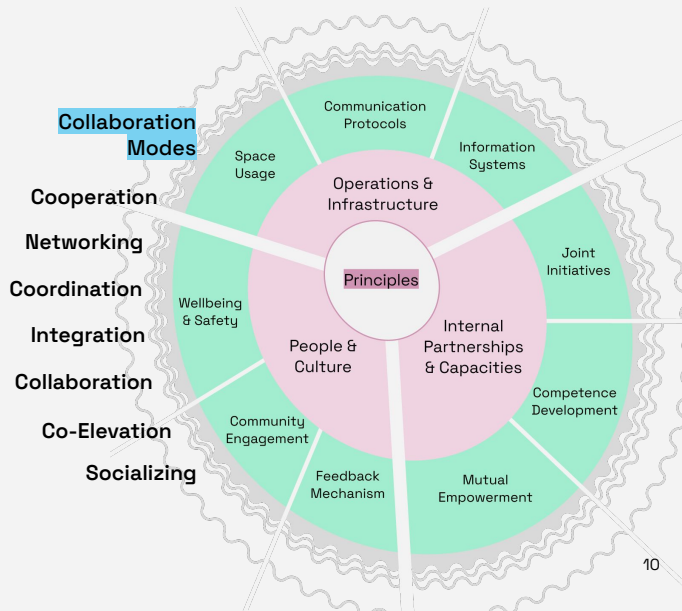
Competence Development

Building internal capacity by enhancing employees' skills, knowledge, and expertise to contribute to cultural centre-wide initiatives.

Program Structure

Practices offer **entry points for different modes of collaboration**. They evolve and take shape in multiple ways through experimentation with practices.

Principles
Labs
Practices
Collaboration Modes
Experiments



Program Structure

Principles
Labs
Practices
Collaboration Modes
Experiments

Cooperation

Executing tangible outcomes together by pooling capacities.

Networking

Making connections that could be mutually beneficial.

Collaboration

Contributing capacities towards aligned goals.

Co-Elevation

Supporting one another to grow and succeed together.

Socializing

Informal interactions which lead to trust and familiarity.

Integration

Working together as a cohesive whole by combining efforts and resources.

Coordination

Aligning efforts to execute activities relevant for both.



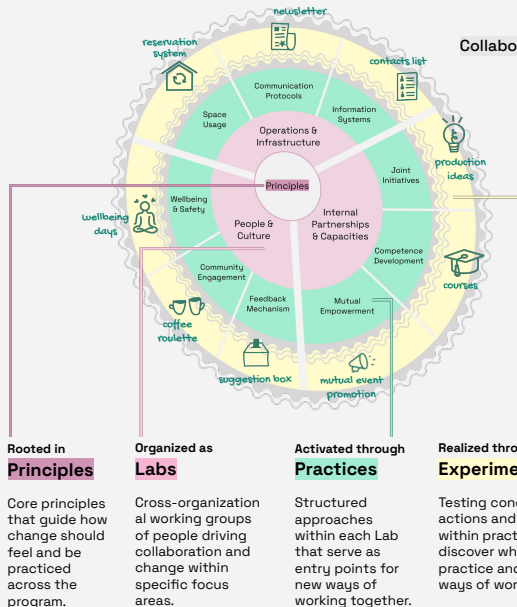
Program Structure

Labs **experiment with concrete actions** and ideas inside their practices to **test new ways of working**.

Feedback and progress are continuously gathered to identify what is effective and what can be sustained over time. This cycle of trying, learning, and adapting makes future change tangible and collective.

The experiments are simply **catalogued examples** gathered during the research phase. However, lab teams independently decide and design their own experiments.

Principles
Labs
Practices
Collaboration Modes
Experiments



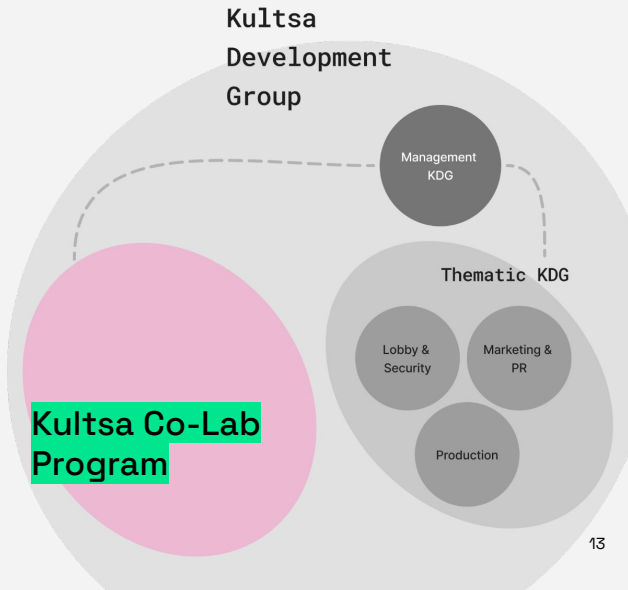
Program Structure

Results are communicated to KDG management, thematic groups, and ECC employees.

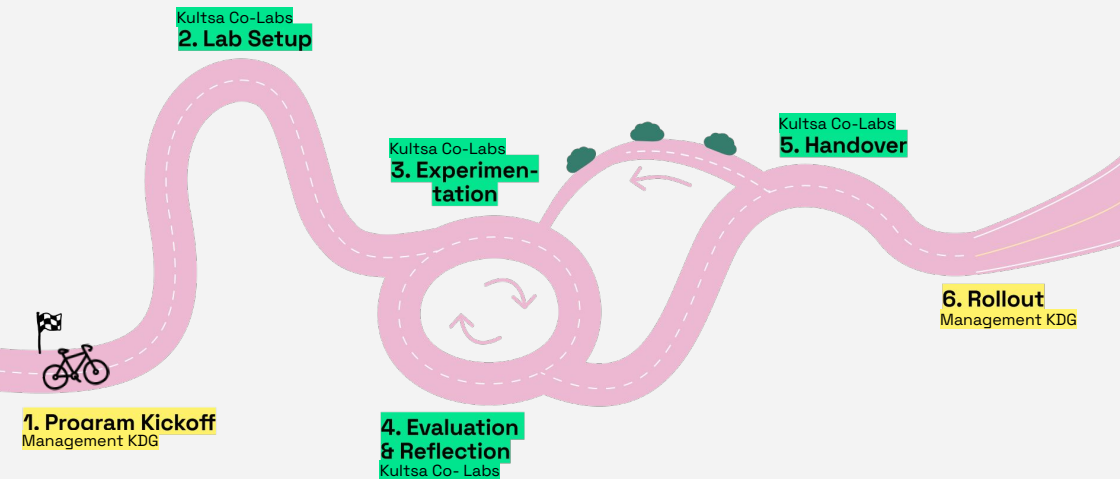
This creates a bridge for **Management to take up outcomes**, embed them into Kultsa's long-term development and allocate the responsibility of implementation to relevant employees.

Meanwhile, the **Lab continues to iterate or experiment** with other emerging ideas.

Principles
Labs
Practices
Collaboration Modes
Experiments



Program Roadmap

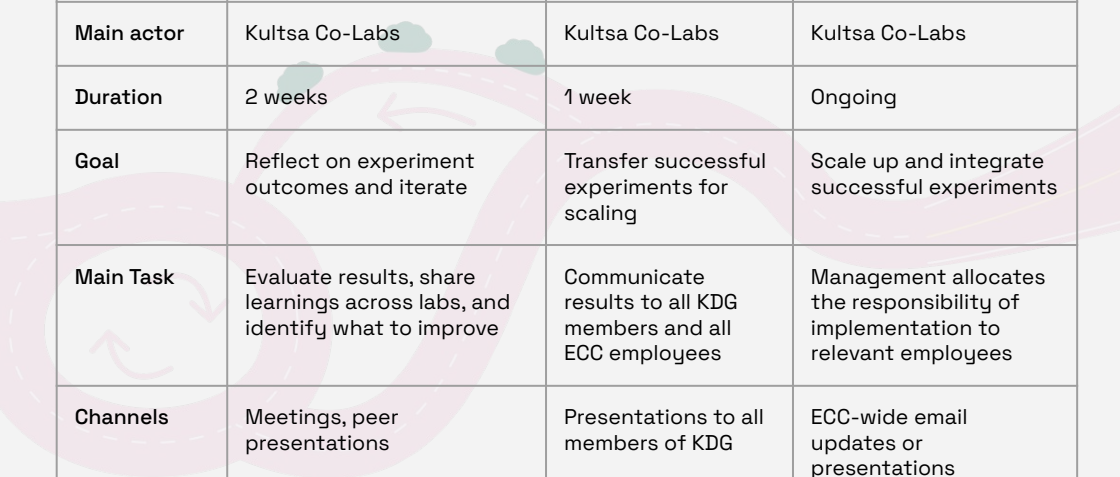


Main Actors:
Management KDG
Kultsa Co-Labs

Program Roadmap

Steps	1.Program Kickoff	2. Lab Setup	3. Experimentation
Main actor	Management KDG	Kultsa Co-Labs	Kultsa Co-Labs
Duration	1 month	1 week	3 months
Goal	Launch the Kultsa Co-Lab Program	Kickstart labs	Test ideas and approaches through experiments
 Main Task	Introduce the Kultsa Co-Lab Program to all employees of the Cultural Centre, build excitement and launch open call for the Labs	Establish team roles and align on common goals	Plan and run experiments, decide how success will be evaluated, collect feedback, and adjust methods as needed
Channels	ECC-wide event and marketing emails	In-person meetings	In-person meetings

Program Roadmap



Steps	4. Evaluation & Reflection	5. Handover	6. Rollout
Main actor	Kultsa Co-Labs	Kultsa Co-Labs	Kultsa Co-Labs
Duration	2 weeks	1 week	Ongoing
Goal	Reflect on experiment outcomes and iterate	Transfer successful experiments for scaling	Scale up and integrate successful experiments
Main Task	Evaluate results, share learnings across labs, and identify what to improve	Communicate results to all KDG members and all ECC employees	Management allocates the responsibility of implementation to relevant employees
Channels	Meetings, peer presentations	Presentations to all members of KDG	ECC-wide email updates or presentations

If you have any questions, please contact:

Johanna Weigel - johanna.svea@gmx.de

Elli Mattila - elli.mattila@gmail.com

Julia Steinebach - juliasteinebachsgn@gmail.com

Sushmita Charlu - sushmitacharlu@gmail.com

